



Know before you build

Forge the Future Hackathon 2026
Finalist briefing
Someshwaran Mohan Kumar · Elastic

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SENIOR DEVELOPER ADVOCATE · ELASTIC

- I look after the Elastic developer community across India and the wider APJ region.
- Before this I spent three years in Elasticsearch Support, so I have seen a lot of clusters built the way I am about to tell you not to build them.
- I run the Elastic User Groups across a dozen Indian cities and Singapore, and the Elastic for Startups programme.
- For these two days I am a mentor, not a judge. Bring me your Elasticsearch and AWS problems.



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You are in the top 20. Now here is what we expect.

- The judging rubric, exactly as it is published on the event page.
- What we mean by using Elasticsearch and AWS properly, not just installing them.
- How the two days work, who your judges are, and who to ask for help.

Ask your technical questions in this session. That is what it is for.

The twenty teams in the finale

01 jazzt builders

02 fovea

03 kaapi and commit

04 ai hero academia

05 sandboxed

06 winner

07 han solo

08 tyr

09 defcon1

10 vinsforge

11 theants

12 outliers

13 techno crackers

14 saikrishna

15 pie square

16 copilotverse

17 eden ai labs

18 syndicate smashers

19 frustrated engineers

20 calyirex

A prize pool of ₹7.5 lakh

FIRST PLACE

₹3,00,000

Plus ₹75K Sarvam AI credits, and you showcase your solution at Elastic{ON} Mumbai.

SECOND PLACE

₹2,00,000

Plus ₹50K Sarvam AI credits for continued development and experimentation.

THIRD PLACE

₹1,00,000

Plus ₹25K Sarvam AI credits to support further development.

The rubric

Published on the event page. Nothing added, nothing hidden.

100 points, five criteria

Criterion	Weight	Breakdown
Innovation	25	Originality 10 · AI Implementation 15
Technical Implementation	30	Elasticsearch Integration 15 · Technology Stack 15
Impact	20	Problem Solving 10 · Market Potential 10
User Experience	15	Interface Design 8 · Usability 7
Presentation	10	Demo Quality 5 · Pitch Effectiveness 5
Total	100	Judges' decisions are final and binding

Ingestion alone is not integration

- Show us how data arrives. Your streams, your pipelines, your index and mapping decisions.
- Show us the retrieval. What queries you run and why you designed them that way.
- Connect it to your LLM. Show the path from a user question to a grounded answer.
- Use Agent Builder if it fits your use case, and show the workflow you built.
- Reach for the wider platform. Webhooks, email actions, and the integrations that suit your problem.

Build your use case around Elasticsearch. We want to see how differently you can use it, not that you used it.

What you get, and when

Elasticsearch

- Start on Elastic Cloud Serverless. Create your project and integrate against it.
- Get comfortable with it before the 18th so you are not learning the console on day one.

AWS

- Test enrolments and a sandbox environment are provided on the finale.
- The specific services available are shared on the 18th. Everyone hears it together.

Sarvam

- On the finale, Sarvam shares a signup link for each team.
- Sign up through that link and your team gets credits to build with.

The rules of the build

Fairness matters more here than anywhere else in the event.

The build starts on 18 September

- Test things out before you arrive. Try approaches, spike ideas, learn the tooling. That is expected.
- If you have already built something, say so. Tell us what existed before and what you built during the event.
- Everyone starts from the same line on the 18th. That is the whole point of running it in one room.

Be honest with us and we will work with you. The repository will tell the story either way.

We hand you the repo on the day

01

YOU GET A FRESH REPO

We create a new private repository for each team on 18 September. You do not need to set one up.

02

ADD YOUR TEAMMATES

Add every member using their GitHub username. Have those usernames ready before you arrive.

03

PUSH DIRECTLY TO IT

All your work goes into that repo across both days, so we can see how the build came together.

Put everything in there: your README, architecture notes, setup steps, and what is real versus stubbed.

Know where your data is going to come from

- Research your sources. Who publishes this data, in what format, and are you allowed to use it.
- Look at a sample and check it is actually the right data. Do the fields you need exist, and is it current.
- If it is synthetic, say it is synthetic. That is fine, and hiding it is not.
- Better still, build a scraper and pull live data. Real, messy, moving data is harder and the effort shows.

Say less, and be able to back all of it

- Every claim technically correct. If you cannot defend it in the Q and A, take it out.
- Cite your numbers. Benchmarks, latencies, accuracy figures. Tell us where they came from.
- Your slides, your diagram and your repository should describe the same system.

The team behind the event

Manish Raj Kunwar

Head of Marketing, India · Elastic
Leading Forge the Future

Komal J. Prabhakar

Regional Marketer, APJ · Elastic
Event coordination

Questions about the event itself rather than the technology are theirs. Today is the rubric and the build.

Your judges

Ravindra Ramnani

Head of Field Engineering, India · Elastic

Sehaj Virk

Head of Strategy and GTM, Model APIs · Sarvam

Ankit Bose

Head of AI · Nasscom

Srinivas Pendyala

Senior Solutions Architect, WW Data and AI · AWS

One judge from each partner. They score against the published rubric, and their decisions are final.

Your mentors

Someshwaran Mohan Kumar

Senior Developer Advocate · Elastic

Ashish Tiwari

Principal Solutions Architect, Search · Elastic

Vinayak Gavariya

AI Engineer, Developer Relations · Sarvam

Udayasimha Theepireddy

Director, Cloud and AI Ecosystem · Elastic · bring AWS questions here

Use all of us. Do not lose four hours to something we could unblock in ten minutes.

Join the Slack channel

- Scan the code to join. If you are already in, you are set.
- Ask product and technical questions here. Elasticsearch, AWS, Sarvam, anything about the stack.
- If something is not answered in today's call, ask it there and we will pick it up.
- Ask early. A question on the 17th is worth far more than the same question on the 18th.



Grand Finale, in person

18 Sept

Doors from around 8:00 am.
Programme starts 9:00 am.

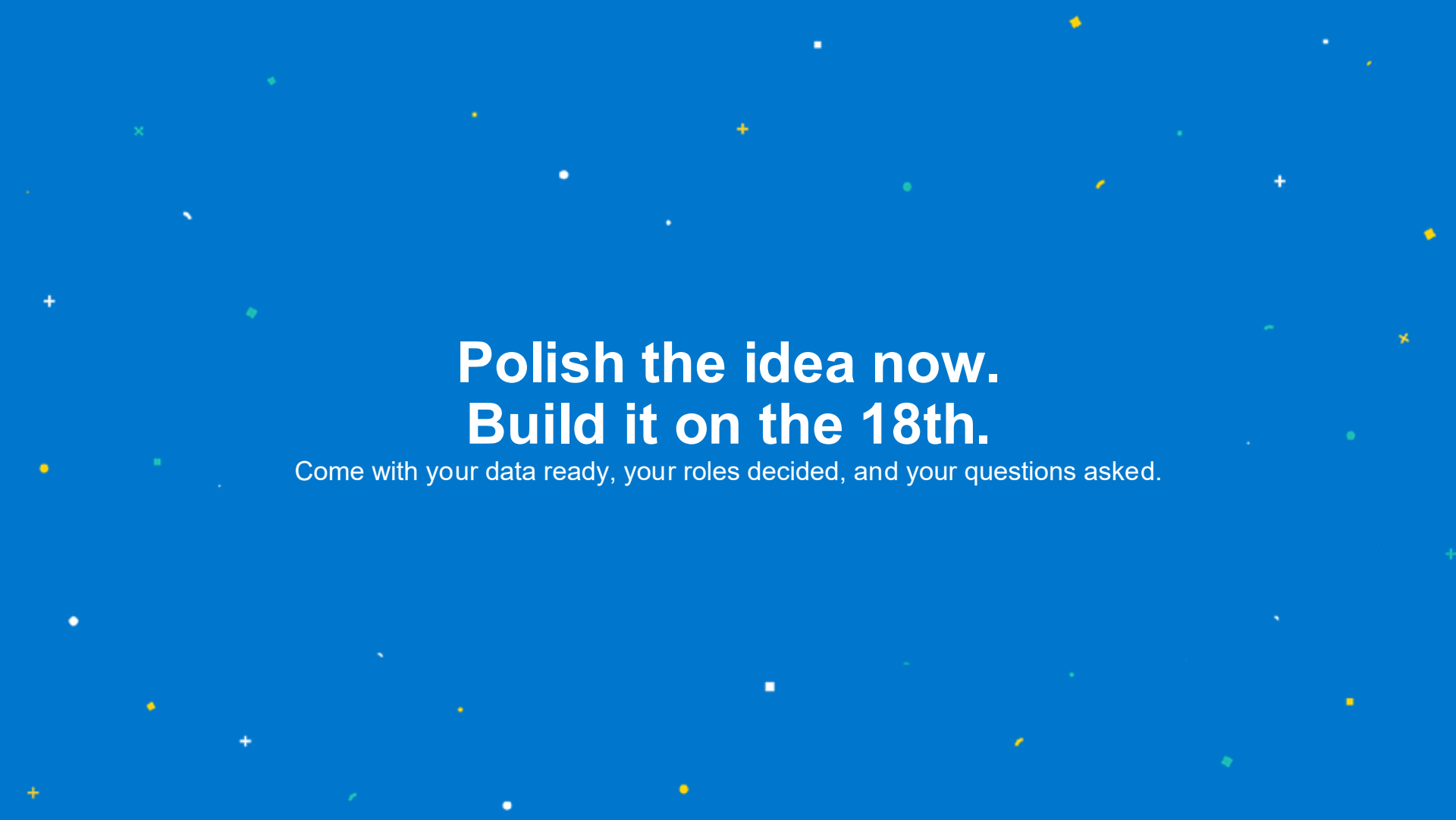
19 Sept

Runs through to 6:00 pm.
Judging and results on day two.

Venue

Elastic office, Bengaluru.
Offline, in person, both days.

Decide your roles before you arrive. Every member should know what they own across the two days.

The background is a solid blue color. It is decorated with numerous small, scattered geometric shapes in white, yellow, green, and orange. These shapes include circles, squares, triangles, and plus signs, creating a festive or confetti-like effect.

Polish the idea now. Build it on the 18th.

Come with your data ready, your roles decided, and your questions asked.